

DECISION READINESS NOTE (DRN-002)

TITLE: INFORMATION ASYMMETRY AND DECISION VISIBILITY IN OPERATIONAL ENVIRONMENTS

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Status: Anonymized | Observational | Non-enforcement

Evidence Basis: Lived Operational Exposure and Ongoing Observation

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1. Context

Domain: Operational / Industrial environments

Decision Surface: Access to timely operational information

2. Observed Structural Pattern

- Formal information channels (e.g., newsletters, notices, updates) are not uniformly accessible across roles.
- Supervisors act as primary intermediaries for operational or safety updates.
- Information dissemination is inconsistent or delayed as it passes through intermediary roles.
- Individuals are held accountable for actions taken under uneven access to context.

3. Decision Reframe

The operative decision is not whether information exists.

The real decision is:

- **Who has timely visibility into the information required for safe and effective action and who does not?**

4. Decision Failure Mode

Failure Type: Informal Information Gating (Structural Friction)

Critical information is transmitted through informal or bandwidth-constrained human channels rather than explicit, role-independent systems.

This creates an asymmetry in which responsibility to act is constant, while visibility needed to act is variable.

5. Accountability Consequence

- Individuals may be held accountable for outcomes influenced by information they did not receive in time.
- Supervisory bandwidth functions as a silent risk factor.
- Errors are interpreted as individual lapses rather than systemic visibility gaps.

6. Decision Readiness Assessment

The system manages tasks and accountability but does not reliably manage:

- functional visibility (ensuring the actor sees what the role requires)
- timing of dissemination
- traceability of who knew what, when

As a result, decision responsibility exceeds decision visibility.

7. Minimal Diagnostic Question

When an operational error occurs, can the system demonstrate that all affected actors had timely access to the specific information required to execute their decision safely?

If not, the system is not decision-ready.

End of DRN-002